Youth Vocational Training Program

Impact Evaluation: Summary of Findings

Baseline (February 2025) and endline (February 2026) survey of 200 young people in East Java

Prepared by Jocelin Helsa · November 2026 · Interactive dashboard: open in Data Studio

All data in this report is synthetic, generated to demonstrate the survey, cleaning and analysis workflow.

200	91.5%	+0.44	+2.5	+15 pp
youth surveyed at baseline	re-interviewed at endline	life-skills gain vs comparison (1–4 scale)	more job applications vs comparison	employment gain vs comparison (not significant)

Executive summary

The training clearly improved young people's life skills and how actively they looked for work. It has not yet been shown to raise employment: trained youth gained more jobs than the comparison group, but the difference is too small for this sample to rule out chance.

- **Life skills improved strongly.** Trained youth gained 0.44 points more than the comparison group on the 1–4 Life Skills Index (95% CI 0.36 to 0.52). The largest gain was in problem solving and critical thinking (+0.57).
- **Job search became more active and more successful.** Trained youth made 2.5 more job applications in the past year than the comparison group (95% CI 1.3 to 3.7) and received twice as many offers per application (15.7% vs 7.9%).
- **Employment rose, but the impact is not yet proven.** Employment went from 35.5% to 60.0% among trained youth and from 28.8% to 38.4% in the comparison group: a 15-point difference (95% CI –5 to +35 points).
- **Participants valued the training, with clear differences by track.** 78% were satisfied and 82% used the skills at work or in job search (NPS +15). Garment & Tailoring and Hospitality had negative NPS and the lowest relevance ratings.

About the evaluation

The evaluation compares youth who completed the training with eligible applicants who were waitlisted, before and 12 months after the training. Because both groups are measured twice, the analysis uses **difference-in-differences (DiD)**: the change among trained youth minus the change in the comparison group. This removes trends that affect everyone, such as a better job market.

Item	Detail
Groups	120 trained youth (treatment) and 80 waitlisted applicants (comparison)
Training tracks	Automotive, Barista & F&B;, Digital Marketing, Garment & Tailoring, Hospitality
Location	Surabaya, Sidoarjo, Gresik, Malang and Mojokerto, East Java, Indonesia
Survey	39-question KoboToolbox questionnaire: profile, 12 life-skills items in 4 domains, employment, income, job search, further learning, training feedback
Analysis sample	183 youth interviewed in both rounds (110 trained, 73 comparison); 8.3% and 8.8% attrition respectively
Baseline balance	Groups were similar before training: 49% vs 48% female, average age 22.1 vs 22.3, employment 32.5% vs 28.7%, Life Skills Index 2.57 vs 2.63
Significance test	Two-sample t-test on each youth's change score; significant when the 95% confidence interval excludes zero

Findings

1. Life skills improved in every domain

The Life Skills Index of trained youth rose by 0.55 points, against 0.11 points in the comparison group. 98% of trained youth improved their score, compared with 60% of the comparison group (SQL Q11). Gains were similar for women (+0.53 vs +0.06) and men (+0.57 vs +0.15), so the training worked equally well for both.

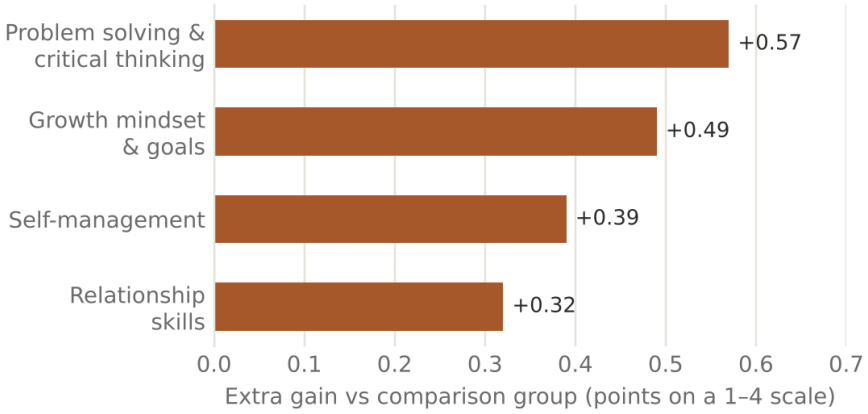


Figure 1. Life-skills impact (DiD) by domain. Source: SQL Q5, dashboard page 3.

2. Job search became more active and more successful

At endline, trained youth made 7.6 applications each (841 ÷ 110) against 6.1 in the comparison group (444 ÷ 73). They also converted applications better: 35% led to an interview (vs 23%) and 15.7% to a job offer (vs 7.9%). In total, 110 trained youth received 132 offers, against 35 offers for 73 comparison youth.

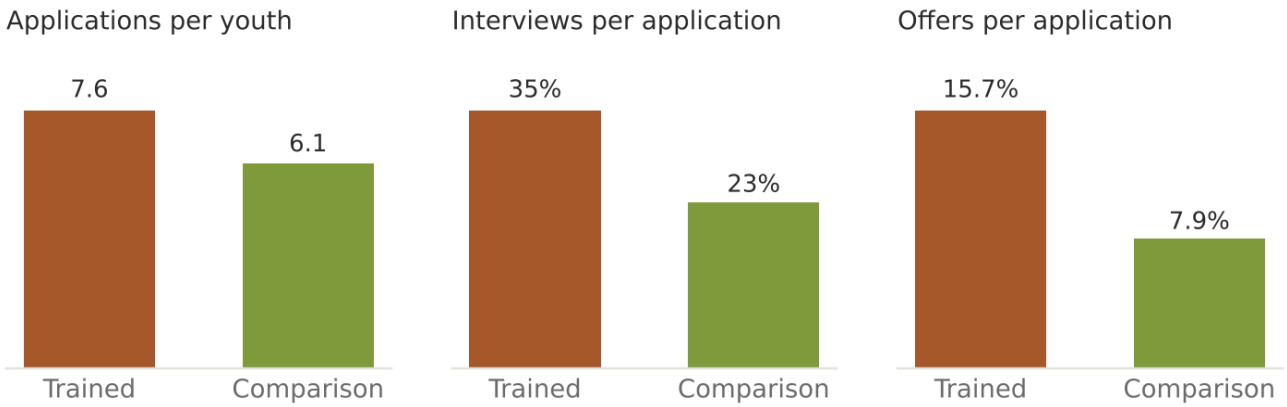


Figure 2. Job search at endline, past 12 months. Source: SQL Q3 and Q7, dashboard page 2.

3. Employment rose more for trained youth, but the gain is not yet statistically significant

Employment among trained youth rose by 24.5 points, against 9.6 points in the comparison group. The 15-point difference is encouraging, but its confidence interval (–5 to +35 points) includes zero. The sample is too small to confirm it: with 183 youth, an employment impact needs to be about 29 points or larger to show up reliably as significant (SQL Q13), and the observed 15 points is below that.

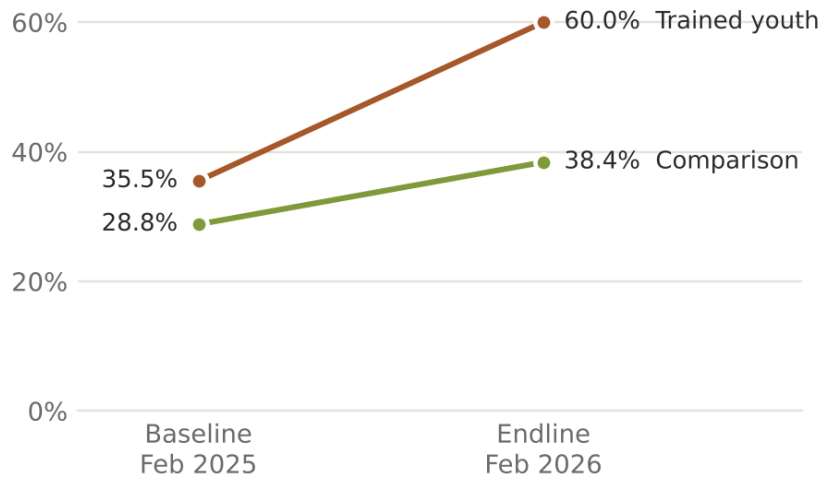


Figure 3. Employment rate at baseline and endline, panel youth. Source: SQL Q3, dashboard page 1.

Between rounds, 43 of 110 trained youth (39%) found work, compared with 20 of 73 comparison youth (27%). However, 16 trained youth (15%) lost work they had at baseline. Job quality did not improve: among employed youth, 41% of trained youth held formal jobs, compared with 46% in the comparison group, and the formal employment impact was close to zero (+3.1 points, not significant). The median monthly income of employed trained youth rose from IDR 2.65M to 3.40M, against 2.80M to 3.25M in the comparison group. Income was not tested for significance, because the group of employed youth changes between rounds.

4. Results differ by training track

Garment & Tailoring had the largest employment gain (15% to 55%) but the lowest relevance rating (3.45 of 5), lowest satisfaction (3.75) and a negative NPS (–5). Hospitality had the smallest employment gain (42.9% to 53.6%) and also a negative NPS (–3.6). Automotive scored highest on NPS (+50) and employment (50% to 83%), though with only 12 youth. Track groups are small (12–29 youth), so these differences are indicative only.

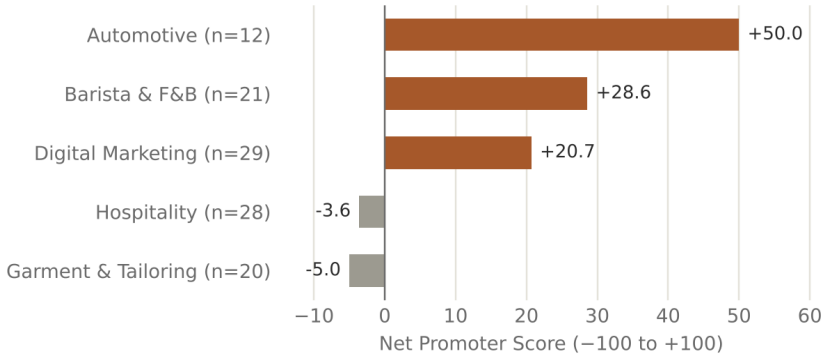


Figure 4. Net Promoter Score by training track, trained youth at endline. Source: SQL Q10, dashboard page 4.

5. Participants rated the training well overall

Of the 110 trained youth interviewed at endline, 78% were satisfied with the training (rated 4 or 5 of 5), 82% had used its skills at work or in job search, and the average relevance rating was 4.0 of 5 (SQL Q10, all-tracks row). The Net Promoter Score was +15: 42 promoters, 42 passives and 26 detractors (SQL Q12).

Summary of impact estimates

Indicator	Change, trained	Change, comparison	Impact (DiD)	95% CI	Significant?
Life Skills Index (1–4)	+0.55	+0.11	**+0.44**	0.36 to 0.52	Yes
Job applications (past 12 months)	+2.70	+0.19	**+2.51**	1.33 to 3.69	Yes
Employment rate	+24.5 pp	+9.6 pp	**+15.0 pp**	–5.1 to +35.1 pp	No
Formal employment rate	+12.7 pp	+9.6 pp	**+3.1 pp**	–10.8 to +17.1 pp	No

pp = percentage points. Panel of 110 trained and 73 comparison youth (70 for life skills, after excluding straight-lined answers). Source: SQL Q4, dashboard page 1.

Data quality

The raw KoboToolbox export held 391 submissions. Fifteen automated checks in the Excel cleaning template flagged 55 of them, and every flag was reviewed and documented in a 59-entry cleaning log. Eight submissions were removed: 2 test entries, 4 duplicates, 1 refusal and 1 interview that a supervisor back-check showed never took place. The final dataset has 383 interviews (200 baseline, 183 endline).

The most common issues were inconsistent city spellings (17 fixes) and duplicate or mistyped respondent IDs. One enumerator (ENUM03) had 21.3 issues per 100 interviews, against 11.5–14.4 for the other four.

Recommendations

1. **Keep and scale the life-skills curriculum.** It has the clearest and largest effect, especially on problem solving and goal setting. Protect these modules in any redesign or budget cut.
2. **Strengthen the link from job search to jobs.** Trained youth apply more and convert better, but the employment gain is not yet proven. Add employer partnerships, job matching and interview preparation in the final weeks of training, and follow up with graduates during their first months in work: 15% of trained youth lost a job they had held at baseline.
3. **Focus on job quality, not only placement.** Trained youth were no more likely to be in formal jobs. Add contract-readiness content (workers' rights, written contracts, social security registration) and target formal employers for placements.
4. **Review the Garment & Tailoring and Hospitality tracks with industry input.** Both have negative NPS, and Garment & Tailoring has the lowest relevance rating despite the largest employment gain. Update the content to match current employer needs, then re-check satisfaction with the next cohort.
5. **Improve the next round of monitoring and evaluation.** To confirm an employment effect of around 15 points, the next evaluation needs roughly 3.5–4 times as many youth (about 650–700 in both rounds) or a longer follow-up. Replace the free-text city question with a drop-down list, and give ENUM03 a refresher on the survey protocol.

Limitations

- **Synthetic data:** figures demonstrate the method and are not results of a real program.
- **Not randomised:** the comparison group is waitlisted applicants. The groups were similar at baseline, but unmeasured differences, such as motivation, may remain.
- **Sample size:** 183 panel youth limit the power to detect employment effects; track-level results rest on 12–29 youth each.
- **Self-reported data:** income, hours and life-skills answers are self-reported and may contain recall or social-desirability bias.
- **Short follow-up:** 12 months may be too soon to see full effects on employment and job quality.

Full charts, filters by track, gender and city, and the data-quality log are in the interactive dashboard.